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Australia's AI Ethics Principles

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How we developed the principles In 2025, we published the [Guidance for AI Adoption](#) ([industry.gov.au/node/95254](https://www.industry.gov.au/node/95254)), which outlines 6 essential practices for safe and responsible AI governance. This updated and simplified guidance for industry evolves the 10 principles from the [Voluntary AI Safety Standard](#) ([industry.gov.au/publications/voluntary-ai-safety-standard](https://www.industry.gov.au/publications/voluntary-ai-safety-standard)) and these 8 AI Ethics Principles.

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AI innovation (<https://www.industry.gov.au/publications?pub-topic=3059>)

AI, technology and innovation (<https://www.industry.gov.au/publications?pub-topic=2945>)

AI technology (<https://www.industry.gov.au/publications?pub-topic=2963>)

Industry, Science and Resources (<https://www.industry.gov.au/publications?publisher=3026>)

The AI Ethics Principles

The AI (Ethics) Principles guided businesses and governments to responsibly design, develop and implement AI. The principles were part of the Australian Government's commitment to be a global leader in responsible and inclusive AI.

The voluntary principles to ensure AI is safe, secure and reliable.

Key points:

The principles aim to deliver more reliable and fairer outcomes for all Australians and to reduce the risk of negative impact on those affected by AI applications. They encourage businesses and governments to practice the highest ethical standards when designing, developing and deploying AI.

5 Principles at a glance

Human, social and environmental wellbeing: AI systems should benefit individuals, society and the environment.

Respect for fundamental values: AI systems should respect human rights, diversity, and the autonomy of individuals.

Inclusiveness: AI systems should be inclusive and accessible, and should not involve or result in unfair discrimination against individuals, communities or groups.

Privacy, data protection and security: AI systems should respect and uphold privacy rights and data protection, and ensure the security of data.

Reliability and safety: AI systems should reliably operate in accordance with their intended purpose.

Transparency and explainability: There should be transparency and responsible disclosure so that individuals can understand when they are being significantly impacted by AI, and can find out when an AI system is interacting with them.

Accountability: When an AI system significantly impacts a person, community, group or environment, there should be a timely process to allow people to challenge the use or outcomes of the AI system.

Human oversight: People responsible for the different phases of the AI system lifecycle should be identifiable, and accountable for the outcomes of the AI systems, and human oversight of AI systems should be enabled.

5 Principles in detail

Human, social and environmental wellbeing

Throughout their lifecycle, AI systems should benefit individuals, society and the environment.

AI systems should be used to clearly indicate from the outset that AI systems should be used for beneficial purposes that benefit individuals, society and the environment. AI system objectives should be clearly identified and aligned with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals. Systems that help address areas of global concern should be encouraged, like the **United Nations Sustainable Development Goals** (<https://www.un.org/sustainabledevelopment/sustainable-development-goals/>) . Ideally, AI systems should be used to benefit all human beings, including future generations.

AI systems used for legitimate internal business purposes, like increasing efficiency, can have both positive and negative impacts on individual, social and environmental wellbeing. Those impacts, both positive and negative, should be accounted for throughout the AI system's lifecycle, including impacts outside the organisation.

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entred values

heir lifecycle, AI systems should respect human rights, diversity, and the autonomy

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s to ensure that AI systems are aligned with human values. Machines should serve he other way around. AI systems should enable an equitable and democratic society by xting and promoting human rights, enabling diversity, respecting human freedom and ndividuals, and protecting the environment.

AI Ethics Principles at a glance

s need to be carefully considered, as AI systems can equally enable and hamper such s. It's permissible to interfere with certain human rights where it's reasonable, oportionate.

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ting with AI systems should be able to keep full and effective control over themselves. l not undermine the democratic process, and should not undertake actions that threaten ny, like deception, unfair manipulation, unjustified surveillance, and failing to maintain n a disclosed purpose and true action.

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heir lifecycle, AI systems should be inclusive and accessible, and should not involve ifair discrimination against individuals, communities or groups.

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s to ensure that AI systems are fair and that they enable inclusion throughout their systems should be user-centric and designed in a way that allows all people to access the related products or services. This includes both appropriate consultation , who may be affected by the AI system throughout its lifecycle, and ensuring people access and treatment.

/ important given concerns about the potential for AI to perpetuate societal injustices ate impact on vulnerable and underrepresented groups including, but not limited to, age, disability, race, sex, intersex status, gender identity and sexual orientation. be taken to ensure the AI produced decisions are compliant with anti-discrimination

Protection and security

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their lifecycle, AI systems should respect and uphold privacy rights and data and ensure the security of data.

s to ensure respect for privacy and data protection when using AI systems. This proper data governance, and management, for all data used and generated by the AI it its lifecycle. For example, maintaining privacy through appropriate data ere used by AI systems. Further, the connection between data, and inferences drawn AI systems, should be sound and assessed in an ongoing manner.

aims to ensure appropriate data and AI system security measures are in place. This ification of potential security vulnerabilities, and assurance of resilience to adversarial measures should account for unintended applications of AI systems, and potential appropriate mitigation measures.

Reliability and safety

their lifecycle, AI systems should reliably operate in accordance with their intended

s to ensure that AI systems reliably operate in accordance with their intended purpose ifecycle. This includes ensuring AI systems are reliable, accurate and reproducible as

I not pose unreasonable safety risks, and should adopt safety measures that are he magnitude of potential risks. AI systems should be monitored and tested to ensure meet their intended purpose, and any identified problems should be addressed with agement as appropriate. Responsibility should be clearly and appropriately identified, an AI system is robust and safe.

Transparency and explainability

be transparency and responsible disclosure so people can understand when they are significantly impacted by AI, and can find out when an AI system is engaging with

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Transparency in AI systems through responsible disclosure is important to each stakeholder for the following reasons:

• To let people know what the system is doing and why

• To help people, including those undertaking the validation and certification of AI, the systems' developers, and input data

• To help people deploying and operating the system, to understand processes and input data

• To help people, not investigators, if accidents occur

• To help people, not investigators, in the context of investigations

• To help people, not investigators, in the legal process, to inform evidence and decision-making

• To help people, not investigators, to build confidence in the technology

Transparency measures should be provided in a timely manner, and provide reasonable justifications for the measures. This includes information that helps people understand outcomes, like key factors influencing the decision-making.

Transparency aims to ensure people have the ability to find out when an AI system is engaging with them (of the level of impact), and are able to obtain a reasonable disclosure regarding the AI system.

Ability

If an AI system significantly impacts a person, community, group or environment, there should be a timely process to allow people to challenge the use or outcomes of the AI system.

Transparency is to ensure the provision of efficient, accessible mechanisms that allow people to understand the use or output of an AI system, when that AI system significantly impacts a person, community, group or environment. The definition of the threshold for 'significant impact' will depend on the context and application of the AI system in question.

Transparency for harm is possible, when things go wrong, is key to ensuring public trust in AI. Compensation should be paid to vulnerable persons or groups.

Transparency is sufficient access to the information available to the algorithm, and inferences drawn, to ensure the system is truly effective. In the case of decisions significantly affecting rights, there should be an opportunity for oversight, which makes appropriate use of human judgment.

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sible for the different phases of the AI system lifecycle should be identifiable and for the outcomes of the AI systems, and human oversight of AI systems should be

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s to acknowledge the relevant organisations’ and individuals’ responsibility for the al systems that they design, develop, deploy and operate. The application of legal ng accountability for AI systems is still developing.

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ld be put in place to ensure responsibility and accountability for AI systems and their cludes both before and after their design, development, deployment and operation. The ndividual accountable for the decision should be identifiable as necessary. They must opriate level of human control or oversight for the particular AI system or use case.

ave a significant impact on an individual’s rights should be accountable to external es providing timely, accurate, and complete information for the purposes of sight bodies.

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nd information and case studies on the National Library’s Trove archive.

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e.nla.gov.au/awa/20250625043338/https://www.industry.gov.au/publications/australias-ice-ethics-framework/testing-ai-ethics-principles)

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dies of how some of Australia's biggest businesses trialled the principles in a pilot program.

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e.nla.gov.au/awa/20250625043350/https://www.industry.gov.au/publications/australias-ice-ethics-principles/developing-ai-ethics-principles)

principles through public consultation and asked the public for input.

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at the department

lustry, Science and Resources

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NT OF COUNTRY

hises the First Peoples of this Nation and their ongoing cultural and spiritual connections to the lands, waters, unities.

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Nations Peoples as the Traditional Custodians and Lore Keepers of the oldest living culture and pay respects d present. We extend that respect to all First Nations Peoples.

urney, 2024 by Chern’ee Sutton

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